

Rules and recommendations for writing bachelor's and master's theses at FI MU

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This document summarizes the basic information you need to know to successfully defend your bachelor's (BP) or master's (DP) thesis, and consists of three parts:

1. **Formal requirements** This section contains mandatory instructions that you must follow.
2. **Requirements for work and assessment** Here you will find out what is expected of you.
3. **Advice** Finally, there are recommendations that should be followed.

A bachelor's or master's thesis is a mandatory part of bachelor's (master's) study programs . Its goal is to develop professional knowledge and skills and train in independent work in solving a large-scale project. It demonstrates mastery of the knowledge prescribed by the bachelor's (master's) study program and the student's ability to use it in solving a specific problem. BP/DP follows the same basic principles, the difference lies in the scope of the work, its complexity and independence. In a bachelor's thesis, the student is expected to demonstrate the ability to work on a large-scale project (for example, to create a useful program) and to be able to place their work in context and describe it in the form of a professional text. In a master's thesis, in addition to the use of more demanding technologies and concepts, greater independence and a creative approach to the problem are also expected .

1 Formal requirements

1.1 Preparation, submission and defense process

The creation, submission, publication and evaluation of theses is subject to [Directive No. 4/2025](#). As you progress through your work, you must adhere to the deadlines set for each step. The exact deadlines for a specific semester are published by the study department in the final study schedule (see deadlines for [bachelor's studies](#)) . and [master's degree](#)). The following table provides an approximate overview of the dates:

	official assignment submission of thesis defense	mid-
autumn semester	October	December
spring semester	March	early February
		late May
		late June

1.1.1 Choice of topic, relation to the study program

Overview [of listed topics](#) Bachelor's and Master's theses are published in the Masaryk University Information System (IS MU). You can also apply for the topic here, but in any case, it is necessary to contact the thesis supervisor at the same time and agree with him on the exact assignment and progress of the work.

You can also suggest your own topic (see Chapter 3: Tips).

The topic of the thesis should have a general relationship to the studied program. In case you are interested if you have a topic that is significantly different from your program, consult with the program sponsor.

1.1.2 Rules for students of joint study programs

Students of joint programs can write their final thesis in both the main and minor programs. The conditions for choosing a topic, writing and defending the thesis are governed by the rules applicable to the main curriculum.

Students of joint programs, who fall under the FI, can therefore work on a topic that falls under the content of the other faculty of study. The thesis should still have at least some IT content relevant to the program being studied. Students can enroll in an analogous subject from the other faculty instead of the SBAPR/SDIPR subject and the requirements for content and format are governed by the instructions of the relevant faculty. However, it is necessary to adhere to all deadlines and formal steps for submitting the thesis according to the FI instructions.

Students from other faculties who study a minor at FI (typically, for example, the Informatics in Education program) enroll in the SBAPR/SDIPR subject at FI and follow FI instructions when writing their thesis. Approval of the official assignment of the thesis is the responsibility of the guarantor of the main study program at their home faculty, and it is also necessary to follow the formal instructions and deadlines of their home faculty.

1.1.3 Subject SBAPR, SDIPR

When solving the BP (DP), you register for the SBAPR (SDIPR) subject, this subject can be registered repeatedly. In total, you must earn 10 (20) credits for the BP (DP), and when you register, you choose the number of credits you want to complete the course in a given semester. You can spread the work on the topic over several semesters or concentrate it on one. It is strongly recommended that the diploma thesis be spread over at least two semesters.

Credit for this course is awarded by the thesis supervisor. As a general rule, the amount of work completed corresponds to the ratio of credits used. Please consult the specific supervisor for the exact conditions for awarding credit.

1.1.4 Subject SOBHA, official assignment

In the semester in which you want to defend your thesis, [you are required to enroll in the SOBHA course](#). This course is worth 0 credits and its registration is considered an application for the defense. You must be registered for the BP/DP topic in the topic package in IS MU (topics [schedule application](#)) [no later than this semester](#).

Check that the title and text of the official assignment are correct. If there is a discrepancy, contact your supervisor and ask them to edit the text.

The official assignment is an important document according to which the work is subsequently evaluated by the committee. Within the deadline given in the schedule for a specific semester (see [the website of the study department](#)) The official assignment must be confirmed in the IS by you, your thesis supervisor and the subject guarantor. After that, it cannot be changed. The thesis supervisor is responsible for the assignment and its meaningfulness. Assignments are checked by subject guarantors, who have the right to reject inappropriate assignments. You can of course play an active role in forming the official assignment (and in the DP this is expected), but your responsibility is primarily to fulfill the specified official assignment.

1.1.5 Language

The title of the thesis in the IS MU must be identical to the title given on the official assignment and must be in the language in which the thesis will be written. The text of the assignment can be in Czech, Slovak or English. For theses written in English, it is recommended to write the assignment in English. The thesis can be written in Czech, Slovak or English. Regardless of the language used, high-quality language editing is expected. The defense takes place in the same language in which the thesis is written. A thesis written in English can also be defended in Czech or Slovak.

1.1.6 Submission and publication of work

Before submitting the final thesis, full credit must be awarded for the SBAPR/SDIPR subjects (i.e. you must have 10 credits for SBAPR and 20 credits for SDIPR). You only submit the electronic version of the thesis to the MU IS Archive. Not only the text, but also all attachments, which typically include the practical part of the thesis, are submitted electronically. The archive must be sufficiently filled out before the thesis is accepted by the study department. During the submission of the thesis, you confirm the Declaration of the Author of the School Work and [the Declaration of Authorship in the IS](#). The submitted version of the final thesis cannot be changed. It must be defended in the submitted form at the final exam.

The electronic version of the thesis and its appendices are publicly available immediately after submission. The author of the thesis can choose a license for his/her work and for the created software, specifying the possibilities of using the work and software, [advice on choosing licenses](#) are listed on the FI website. In general, we recommend more liberal licenses such as BSD or Apache.

Final theses are public by law. If the work or part of it cannot be published immediately (e.g. due to filing a patent), the law allows the work to be hidden for a maximum of 3 years. The Faculty of Informatics often solves theses in cooperation with commercial companies, which often have problems with publishing some parts of the work. Possible conflicts need to be resolved when choosing a topic and discussed thoroughly when creating the assignment (see chapter 3.1).

1.2 Structure of the work

The thesis has the following structure (it is recommended to use the LATEX template [fithesis for typesetting](#), which allows all necessary mandatory and optional parts specified by [the directive to be typed uniformly](#)):

- Title page
- Authorship statement
- Summary and keywords
- Contents
- Own text of the work
- Literature
- Attachments
- Index (optional, relevant especially for DP)

1.2.1 Title page

The following information is included on the title page: Masaryk University, Faculty of Informatics, Diploma/ Bachelor's thesis, title from the assignment (not mandatory), student's first and last name, year of submission. The information provided is appropriately placed on the title page.

1.2.2 Statement of authorship

The title page is followed by a sheet with the student's declaration of authorship and literature used:

I declare that this work is my original work of authorship, which I developed independently. All sources, references, and literature used or excerpted during elaboration of this work are properly cited and listed in complete reference to the due source. or English *Hereby I declare*

that this thesis is

my original authorial work, which I have worked out on my own. All sources, references, and literature used or excerpted during elaboration of this work are properly cited and listed in complete reference to the due source.

You will confirm this statement in the MU IS when submitting your thesis. Therefore, read the statement carefully and make sure that you have really followed it when writing your thesis. Plagiarism is a serious offense that is not only a reason for the unsuccessful defense of the thesis (failure of the assessment), but also for possible disciplinary action. Any literally taken text must be stated in such a way that it is clear from the context that it is a literally taken text (e.g. by placing the text in quotation marks) and must be immediately followed by a citation to the source. It is also necessary to state the sources of paraphrased or translated texts, and it is also necessary to properly refer to the sources of taken images, tables, datasets or libraries - in short, everything that you use in your thesis and that was created by someone else. Do not take this fact lightly and find out what you can do to [avoid plagiarism](#).

On this sheet, or on another sheet, you can thank those who provided you with professional assistance in preparing your work.

1.2.3 Statement on the use of artificial intelligence

In connection with the progressive emergence of artificial intelligence (AI) services, it is quite natural to use these services when writing the text of final theses. In accordance with [the university's position on the use of artificial intelligence in teaching](#) and [recommendations for the use of artificial intelligence tools in fulfillment of study obligations](#) The Faculty of Informatics supports activities aimed at making students' work more efficient and using resources appropriately. However, it is important to remember that even artificial intelligence can provide limited or incorrect information. Therefore, if you decide to use AI services when writing your final thesis, remember the following:

1. Think critically and do not accept texts provided by artificial intelligence without thinking.
2. Indicate which parts of the text you wrote in your own hand and which are taken verbatim. Be aware that when reading the text, it is easy to notice that different parts of the text have different authors, because everyone (even artificial intelligence) uses their own unique expressive apparatus and favorite words.
3. Also include other uses of AI services, e.g. for literature research, structure design, reformulation own thoughts, etc.
4. Remember that you will publish the text, which means that you are responsible for all the content of the work. ourselves – even for the one generated by artificial intelligence.

The declaration on the use of artificial intelligence tools does not have a strictly prescribed form. You can However, be inspired by the following examples:

I used ChatGPT (<https://chat.openai.com/>) to prepare this work. for the purpose of spelling correction. After using this tool, I have checked the content and take full responsibility for it.

During the preparation of this thesis, I used the following AI tools:

- Grammarly for grammar check,
- Github Copilot for faster code writing,
- ChatGPT to improve my writing style.

I declare that I used these tools in accordance with the principles of academic integrity. I checked the content and took full responsibility for it.

Artificial intelligence tools change very quickly, so this document does not list them.

The reasons for using tools may also be increasing, typically these are: text proofreading, style editing, abstract generation, chapter and section heading generation, faster code generation, literature research.

It is advisable to place the statement on the use of artificial intelligence tools on the same page as the statement on authorship.

1.2.4 Summary and keywords

The summary of the work takes up no more than one page, followed by a list of keywords separated by commas (usually 5 to 10). A keyword also means a concept expressed in more than one word (collocation). Keywords should describe the issue being addressed in the thesis and not a list of technologies used.

1.2.5 The actual text of the thesis

The first chapter of the thesis is an introduction that serves to place the problem being addressed in a broader context. The introductory chapter must clearly formulate the objectives of the thesis, and may also provide the structure of the thesis in the form of a brief description of the content of the individual chapters. This is followed by an analysis of the problem and a description of the solution. The final chapter contains an evaluation of the achieved results with special emphasis on the own contribution and an evaluation from a broader perspective of the problem being addressed. In conclusion, it is appropriate to state possible directions for further research or development.

1.2.6 Literature

Consistent referencing of sources is an important element of a professional text. One of the goals of final theses is precisely training in working with literature, and therefore this aspect is also emphasized when evaluating the work. Citing taken parts of the text and images (see above) is absolutely crucial. It may also be appropriate to cite, for example: original sources of terms used, similar systems, sources of statements or data used, literature providing a deeper analysis of terms, methodologies or algorithms mentioned in the work (see also the overview of types of works below). Pay attention to the selection of appropriate sources (in particular, it is not appropriate when a large part or even all of the sources are websites or Wikipedia articles), see also the notes in the advice below. Each item in the list of used literature must be referenced in the text.

1.2.7 Attachments

Place in the appendices those parts of the work that are not essential to the main idea of the work, e.g. a manual for using the created system, fragments of the source text, detailed diagrams and detailed descriptions of the solved parts of the project.

An important part of the thesis are the appendices, which typically represent the implementation part of the thesis. The appendices should include all materials created as part of the thesis, appropriately arranged and commented on (they are part of the evaluation). The appendices *must* be stored in the Archive in the MU IS. The thesis must include a list of appendices and a brief descriptive comment, usually in the text part of the Appendix.

1.3 Defense

The defense of a bachelor's or master's thesis is part of the state final examination and takes place before the state examination commission. The thesis is assessed by its supervisor and one opponent. You have the right to familiarize yourself with the assessments of the thesis supervisor and the opponent of the thesis at least five working days before the defense. You can defend the thesis if you have met the conditions set by the study program (number of credits, completed courses).

During the defense, you are expected to have a presentation prepared in PDF format with embedded fonts. Presentations are collected in advance and copied to a computer prepared in the classroom where the defenses take place. Before the defense, you will receive explicit information by email from the study department on how to proceed.

Using your own laptop (e.g. to demonstrate a created program) is possible, but not recommended and is at your own risk (time spent solving technical problems will be deducted from your presentation time). Please consult your thesis supervisor or committee chair about using your own laptop.

In total, you have 15 minutes for the defense of the thesis and 30 minutes for the defense of the dissertation. You have 8 minutes for the opening speech during the defense of the thesis and 15 minutes during the defense of the dissertation. The rest of the time is devoted to familiarizing the committee with the assessments of the supervisor and opponent, the student's responses to the comments made in the assessments, and the student's reactions to the comments and questions of the committee members (and possibly other guests).

2 Assignment and assessment requirements

This section describes the expectations for final theses at FI and outlines the assessment criteria. These are basic guidelines, not exhaustive and precise regulations – each work is specific and assessment cannot be mechanical.

2.1 Work evaluation

When evaluating, the committee primarily takes into account whether and how the submitted work meets the assignment. The committee naturally takes into account the differences in the difficulty of individual assignments. A simple assignment is required to be completed in detail, and the scope of the work performed will be strongly considered.

Minimalistic fulfillment of a simple assignment will almost certainly lead to rejection of the work. With an ambitious assignment, minor shortcomings and deviations from the assignment can be tolerated.

Three basic components contribute to the evaluation:

1. own work performed (what this means depends on the type of work (see below), it can be, for example, the usability of the implementation, the quality of the design or the originality of the proposed algorithm),
2. processing the written part of the thesis (logical structure of the text, work with literature, adherence to spelling rules and technical terminology, typographical arrangement),
3. defense of the thesis before a committee.

In order to defend your thesis, it is necessary that all three basic components have a certain basic level. Even an excellent implementation is not acceptable if the text of the thesis is completely outdated, contains a large number of grammatical errors, or if you have not prepared a defense.

Your approach to solving the task also contributes marginally to the evaluation (e.g. whether you worked continuously, communicated with your supervisor).

2.2 Scope of work

All ranges below are calculated without attachments:

- The recommended length of the written part of the thesis is 40 standard pages for the BP and 50 standard pages for the DP.
- Minimum range set by [the directive](#) there are 20 standard pages for BP and 30 standard pages for DP.
- The maximum scope is 60 standard pages for BP and 70 standard pages for DP.

A work shorter than the specified minimum scope or longer than the maximum scope is assessed with a grade of *failed*. One standard page is 1800 characters, while images included in the text are counted towards the scope of the written work by estimating the amount of text that would print the same size area in the resulting document - however, only the original images are counted. An image that is merely redrawn is considered to be taken over, i.e. the source must be stated and is not counted towards the scope.

2.3 Basic types of final theses at FI

There are many different types of final theses at FI, which differ from each other in what is expected of them. Here is a description of several basic categories. This is only an indicative list, not all works can be easily classified into the listed categories. Often, works can be on the edge between the listed categories (for example, a combination of implementation and experimental work).

2.3.1 Implementation work

This is probably the most common type of final thesis at FI. The practical output of the thesis is an implementation, preferably one that is used not only by the author at the time of submission. An important part of the evaluation is the quality of the created code, including documentation.

The body of the paper describes the overall design and key points of the implementation, i.e. those that are specific to the problem (not procedures that are standard in the field). The body of the paper may be slightly shorter than the recommended length, especially if the quality of the implementation "speaks for itself." The list of references may be shorter compared to other types of papers, however, even here, at least a high-quality overview of related solutions is expected.

Include source code samples only if justified (key part of the solution, analysis of special syntax). When describing the technologies used, do not discuss standard technologies (it is not necessary to state that Java is an object-oriented language). Discuss the reasons for choosing specific technologies and, if applicable, describe new (less than two years old) and specialized (not found in any FI subject) technologies.

2.3.2 Experimental and evaluation work

Here too, the practical part of the work plays an important role, but it is not about creating a new system, but primarily about comparing existing approaches (algorithms, techniques, systems, implementations). The implementation part can therefore be relatively simple (e.g. using existing implementations or libraries, installing programs), the emphasis is placed on the quality of the experimental or evaluation part, e.g. on data selection, methodology for conducting experiments, processing analyses.

The text part focuses on explaining the approaches being compared and, above all, on describing the experiments performed, analyzing the results and drawing conclusions from these experiments. In this case, a rather longer text is expected, which is usually natural for this type of work.

2.3.3 Concept design, prototype implementation

The thesis deals with a practical problem (does not contain theoretical results), but does not contain an implementation part, or the implementation part is only a prototype that was used only by the author at the time of submission. If the thesis is of this type, it must be clearly evident from the official assignment that the thesis was intended as such by the supervisor (it is not permissible for the thesis to change from an implementation to a concept design due to lack of time).

Compared to other types of work, a particularly high-quality and relatively long text is expected that analyzes and justifies the submitted proposal, e.g. an explicit analysis of what is non-trivial about the proposal, an analysis of possible alternatives, a justification for the choice. High-quality work with literature is expected (e.g. an overview of relevant concepts, sources of information for the choices made).

2.3.4 Theoretical work

This type of thesis is found mainly in the Theoretical Computer Science program. The thesis does not contain any practical part (or only a very rough implementation of the "proof-of-concept"), but it contains theoretical results, e.g. formulation and proof of a statement, design of an algorithm and proof of its correctness.

2.3.5 Review work

The thesis contains an overview of existing approaches (algorithms, techniques, systems, methodologies), does not contain an implementation part and is not theoretically demanding. Such work can be very beneficial, but it is difficult to make it really good (it is definitely not an easier branch compared to implementation work).

Good literature review is particularly important for this type of work. The work must not be just a "cut and paste" compilation; it must, for example, include a synthesis of knowledge from various sources and their comparison. The work must clearly state its contribution compared to a simple compilation.

2.3.6 Work with a creative focus

This type of work is only possible for students of the Bachelor's degree program Informatics with a specialization in Graphic Design or for students of the follow-up Master's degree program Visual Informatics with a specialization in Graphic Design. In IS, these topics are marked with the AGDM label. Students of the specialization/specialization in Graphic Design can also choose other topics, but they must be approved as suitable by the specialization/specialization guarantor.

The bachelor's thesis deals with an artistic problem in connection with computer science and information technologies. The scope of the work corresponds to the prescribed standard, with the text part itself describing the theoretical basis for the artistic part of the work. The text also contains a description of the work process of the artistic work, its decisive creative phases (concept, sketches, implementation, variants, etc.). The work is perfectly documented both in the text and in the appendices. The artistic solution is a direct part of the text of the work and is included in its scope. The work may also include a separate appendix outside the work itself, if required by the assignment, type and scope of the artistic part of the work, for example, a book design, graphic manual, film, photo book, printed matter model, web design.

In this type of work, in addition to the implicitly assumed quality of the text and image attachments, the original solution to the artistic problem and its professional artistic level, including the typographic qualities of the presentation during the defense, are very important.

The diploma thesis, which focuses on an artistic theme, also consists of at least one third of the IT part. In the IT part, the researcher describes the IT resources used in solving the artistic theme and, if applicable, other theoretical knowledge. Cooperation with a professional consultant is recommended; a separate peer review is prepared for the IT part during the evaluation.

For diploma theses in the field of fine arts, a deeper knowledge of artistic principles, a more serious topic of work and a larger scope of work are expected; artistic professionalism closely linked to proven knowledge of computer science is a given here.

3 Tips

3.1 Choosing a topic

An overview of the listed topics for bachelor's and master's theses is published in IS MU. If none of the listed and not yet selected topics suit you, try contacting one of the potential supervisors dealing with the area you are interested in. You can ask them to suggest a topic or suggest a topic yourself. You will certainly find inspiration for a number of interesting topics if you are interested in the activities of the FI, CVT and ÚVT laboratories. It is also possible to solve a topic assigned by a commercial company. In such a case, you must find a suitable pedagogical supervisor among the FI teachers, who will primarily oversee the content and formal requirements of the work and ensure that the topic will be entered into the package of topics in IS MU. Finding a suitable supervisor can be done with the help of a field guarantor, but in some cases they can help you with advice. However, it is not their duty to find a suitable supervisor for this type of work.

For topics that involve work for a commercial company, it is necessary to think carefully and agree on the assignment. In cases where it will not be possible to publish some facts (e.g. source codes, company know-how), this must be clarified in advance. Only the submitted final thesis can be evaluated, which will be published in accordance with the law. Any supplements to the thesis that remain non-public cannot be evaluated. For a successful defense, it is not necessary to include in the bachelor's or master's thesis all the source codes that were created while working for the company (for proprietary software, we recommend that you include and thus publish illustrative parts of the code in the thesis). It is important that the submitted thesis contains sufficient data for the opponent and the examination committee to assess the quality and evaluate the final thesis. If the specific situation in the company or the intended topic does not allow this, it is necessary to choose a different topic for the final thesis.

When choosing a topic, pay attention to the person of the supervisor. Find out what work the supervisor has supervised so far, read his/her reviews, and see what grades the students ultimately received. Based on this, you can get an idea of what to expect from the supervisor. Before your first consultation with the supervisor, prepare yourself – look at the related terms, think about the questions, and clarify what you actually want to do (what type of work, what schedule).

3.2 Writing a thesis

An excellent source of advice on writing a text is, for example, the books [3, 4, 5], which are available in MU libraries. [The Internet Language Guide](#) will certainly help you with writing in Czech. or grammar checker [Proofreader](#). Information about spelling rules and literary forms of Slovak words can be found on the pages [of the Dictionary Portal of the L. Štúr Institute of Linguistics](#). Here we especially recommend [the Rules of Slovak Spelling](#), [A short dictionary of the Slovak language](#) and [Paradigms of nouns](#). Grammarly will help with writing in English, if capacity allows, including with the [Grammarly for Education license](#).

Don't be afraid to let AI rewrite parts of your text. Try different prompts for proofreading, text shortening, and professional style. Have section titles suggested. When using AI, follow the guidelines in section 1.2.3.

3.2.1 Style

The final thesis must be written in a professional style. The essential specifics compared to other functional styles (e.g. journalistic or artistic) are precision, clarity, emotional neutrality and logical argumentation.

By accuracy, we mean choosing the right vocabulary. Find technical terms for your topic, define them (preferably with reference to technical literature), and use them wherever necessary. Stick to one term, even if there are more than one (you can of course mention them).

Every term must have a definition, the only exceptions are terms that are known to the IT community, e.g. command, program. Every abbreviation must be defined the first time it appears, the only exceptions are generally known abbreviations (USA, IBM). Accuracy also involves providing verifiable data (which is a big difference from journalistic practice).

Clarity is important for the reader to navigate through a complex text. For greater clarity, use decimal numbering (Chapter 1, Section 1.1, Subsection 1.1.1), cross-references ("as mentioned in Section 1.2"), footnotes, numbered and referenced figures, tables, diagrams, equations. Don't be afraid to refer to other parts of the text in individual sections; remember that a professional text is rarely read continuously from beginning to end.

The professional text is emotionally neutral, i.e. it does not contain expressions of joy, regret or surprise. It does not contain an evaluation of one's own work or an appeal to the reader.

Correct logical argumentation begins with the coherence of individual parts of the text. The basic unit of a professional text is a paragraph, but the text must also be coherent at the level of sentences and clauses (beware of long clauses that deal with multiple topics). Individual paragraphs lead to the logical construction of arguments with which you support your claims. It must be clear for each paragraph why it is in the text at all.

Typical errors and problems that occur in final theses are as follows:

- use of slang and unwritten expressions (even though, too),
- deviation from a professional style to a journalistic style (use of metaphors),
- replacement of technical vocabulary with marketing vocabulary (e.g. frequent use of "technology" and "solution" where a more precise term exists),
- repetition of words (just, therefore, relative pronouns),
- bastardization and incorrect work with technical terms,
- use of Slovakized Czech words in Slovak text (question, recommendation),
- accumulation of forms ending in "ní" (termination, introduction, control),
- word order errors and cumbersome wording,
- poor structure of the work, e.g. too many short chapters, uneven distribution of the text between chapters,
- the occurrence of redundant parts, e.g. in the theoretical part of the work, concepts are discussed that are further they don't use it at all.

3.2.2 Literature, citations

A bibliographical citation is a summary of data about a cited publication or part of it, allowing its identification.

A reference to a citation is different from a bibliographical citation, which is understood as a reference in the text to a citation given elsewhere. The rules for creating bibliographical citations and their inclusion in professional publications are given in ČSN 01 0197. A detailed analysis of the creation of citations is offered, for example, [in the publication](#)

on Elportál. In computer science, the common style of citation is using serial numbers (as in this text), but you can also use references by name and year of publication (e.g. [Gruber, 1969]) or by abbreviation (e.g. [Gru68]), but always consistently. The most common errors when working with literature include:

- insufficient scope of work with literature, or insufficiently high-quality or varied sources (see below),
- inconsistent citations (e.g. some citations include the author's first name and others do not, different typesetting styles for individual items),
- missing information in citations (e.g. conference name for conference papers, timestamp for electronic sources),
- not citing quotes from the text.

A typical problem is the excessive use of web resources, and specifically Wikipedia. Several notes on this issue:

- One of the goals of a final thesis is to demonstrate that you can work with expert sources. If (almost) all the references are to Wikipedia, then you are not demonstrating this ability very well.
- Quality Wikipedia articles usually contain links to original sources. Try to find a relevant original source and cite it directly.
- There are cases where it may be relevant to cite Wikipedia (e.g. we want to refer the reader to a well-written analysis of a concept that is important for understanding the work), however, in most cases it is more relevant to cite, for example, the original professional article, technical standard or standard textbook on the topic.

Similar notes apply to teaching materials (slides) or documentation of a programming language or library.

3.2.3 Rate

The recommended typesetting method is to use the LATEX system and [the fithesis style](#). This will naturally allow you to focus on the content, as style offers a separation of form and content. The design of the form has been designed to adhere to basic typographic conventions. If you are not sure of your knowledge of them, consider enrolling in the course PB029 *Electronic Document Preparation*, which aims to provide typographic awareness when writing technical and structured texts such as theses.

If you want to use a different typesetting system, follow these basic tips: the page size is A4; choose the font and the width of the typesetting mirror so that the number of characters per line does not exceed 75 characters. Leave more white space on the outer spine and at the bottom, use headers and footers for orientation and navigation in the text. For the main text, we recommend a font (antique, for example Palatino) with a size (size) of twelve points and a line spacing of 120 percent of the size of the main font used (for example 15 points).

Pay attention to typographic principles, common mistakes include:

- quotation mark rate,
- ignoring the difference between a dash and a hyphen or separator,
- line and page breaks (widows and orphans),

- spaces for punctuation marks and quotes,
- inconsistent use of punctuation in lists and descriptions of figures (tables).

To refresh your knowledge of the rules, we recommend *the Typographic Manual* [1] or [2].

3.3 Defense

There is a lot of advice in books and on the internet about preparing presentations. So again, we will only mention a few tips specific to defenses and common mistakes.

The aim of the defense is not to present the topic and results of your work in detail to the audience (i.e. the committee) (this is usually not even possible within the time limit), but above all to convince the committee that you have fulfilled what is expected of the final thesis. The defense should clearly state what you did for work, what your contribution is. The purpose is to "sell" your work. The members of the committee are not

necessarily experts in the specific area of your work, but they do have a general overview of computer science. Consider carefully which aspects of the topic are generally known (do not discuss them) and which are specific and important for your topic (introduce them). Introduce abbreviations that are not widely known or avoid them altogether.

The committee does not know your work in advance, so during the defense, the committee members often leaf through the work, i.e. not everyone always follows all the slides, which does not mean that they do not listen to what you say. Be prepared for this .

The committee is not informed in advance about the assessments, they will be heard after your presentation. Therefore, do not include the responses to the comments in the main presentation, present them only after the assessments have been read. It may be appropriate to prepare "bonus" slides with responses to the comments.

A common mistake is a bad time estimate – the student finishes halfway through the presentation and it seems that he does not have much to say, or on the contrary, he runs out of time halfway through the presentation and does not get to the most important thing (what he was doing). Be sure to try your defense at least once, preferably in front of an audience of at least one person and with a timer.

Reference

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- [3] Světla ýmejková, František Daneš, and Jindra Svýtlá. *How to write a professional text*. LEDA, 1999.
- [4] Lyn Dupré. *Bugs in Writing: A Guide to Debugging Your Prose*. Addison-Wesley, 2nd edition, 1998.
- [5] Justin Zobel. *Writing for Computer Science*. Springer, 2nd edition, 2004.